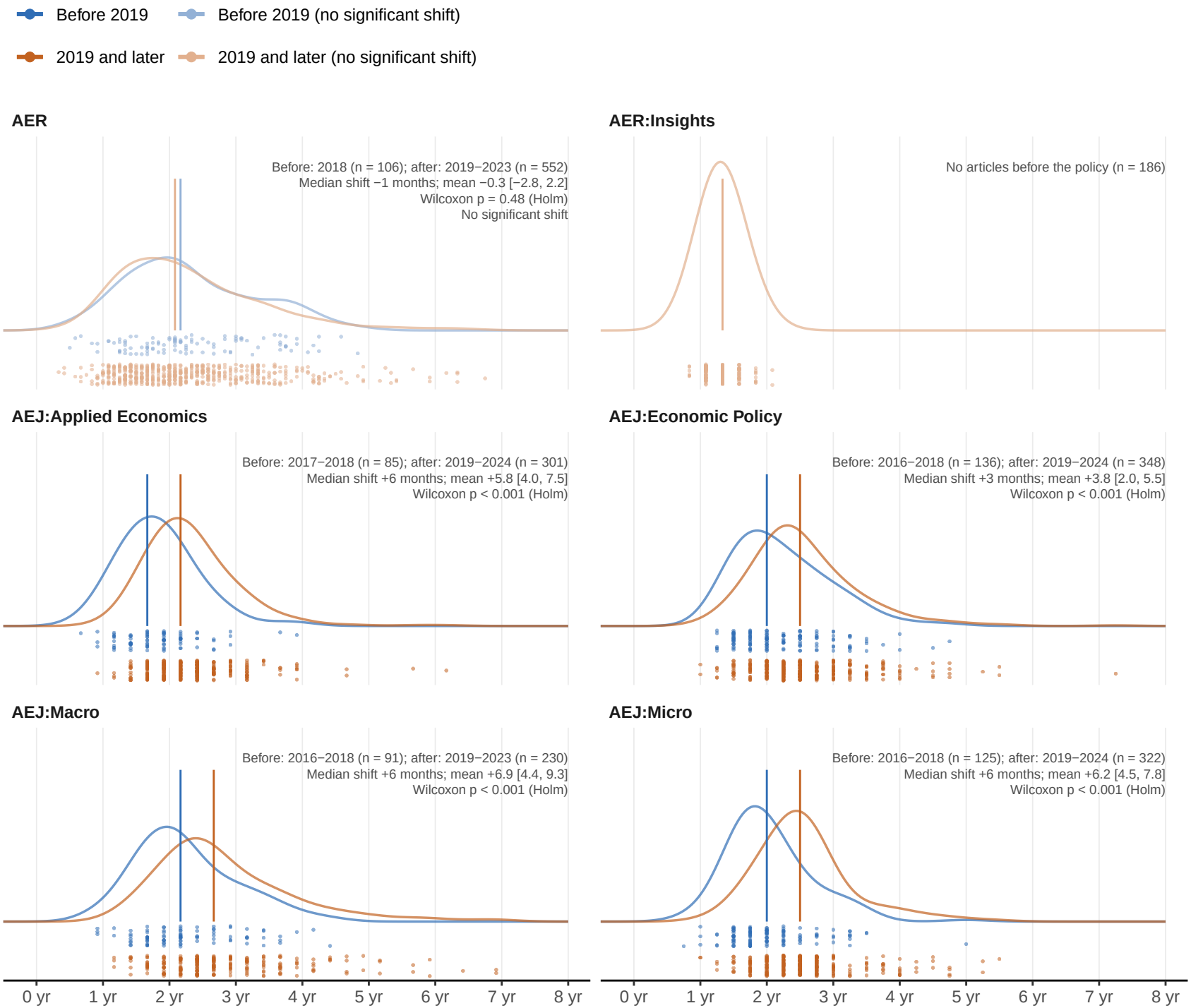
Delay from submission to publication, before and after the 2019 AEA data policy

By year of publication. Vertical lines: medians. Median shift: Hodges−Lehmann estimate (after minus before); mean: difference in means, Welch 95% CI.
Muted colors: no significant shift (Wilcoxon rank−sum, Holm−adjusted across journals, 5% level). Points: upper row before, lower row after.



Submission: year and manuscript number from the DOI (e.g., 10.1257/aer.20151234). Within a submission year, the quartiles of the manuscript numbers of all published articles define the submission quarter (dated at its middle). Only submission years with at least 80% of their published articles observed with such a DOI are used, and only publication years with at least 90% of articles from those submission years. Publication: month of the print issue. Delays fall on a grid of 3 months for the AEJs (quarterly issues), so the median shift is a multiple of 3 months.
Points: articles (jittered vertically). Lines: kernel density (bandwidth 4 months). Excluded: AEA P&P, JEL, JEP (no submission−based numbering).